TCA EASTERN DIVISION · YORK TRAIN FAIR

CLEM'S YORK PRIMER

Fall 2026 · Monday, Oct 19 to Saturday, Oct 24

York Expo Center, 334 Carlisle Ave, York, PA 17404

ADMIT ONE
YORK
OCT 2026

Edited by Ryan Newman, TCA 07-60779 · conrail5065@yahoo.com
Namesake: Richard "Clem" Clement, TCA Honor Roll #64-987

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Richard "Clem" Clement, in his honor

THE ESSENTIALS

Everything you need on one screen. The official word on the meet is always the York Train Fair Member Notice (Dealer Notice) and easterntca.com. Last-minute changes are posted on the Calendar of Events posters around the grounds.

Phone numbers to save

EMERGENCY	York Expo: 717-848-2596
CALL CENTER	Eastern Division: 585-683-9333
LOST & FOUND	Bob Heine: 301-585-1280
RV PARKING	John Seresky: 518-234-4108

Free Wi-Fi on the grounds

Pick the network named after the building you are in (the fairgrounds name, not the hall color; see the hall decoder).

Password: **yec#2026!!**

Public, unsecured network. Avoid banking on it.

Who gets in where

Public Pre-Show (🟪 **Purple** Hall, Mon to Thu): free and open to everyone.

Members Access Friday/Saturday (🟦 **Blue**, 🟥 **Red**, ⬜ **Silver**, ⬜ **White**, 🟧 **Orange**, 🟪 **Purple**, ⬛ **Black**): TCA members and registered guests. Guests and the public can see the whole fair, member halls included, one time only for $20 (Silver Hall desk or Orange Hall ticket window).

Public Access Saturday Only (🟧 **Orange**, 🟪 **Purple**, ⬛ **Black**): adults $25 wristband at the Orange Hall lobby. Kids 18 and under free with an adult.

Badges, maps, help

Registration and badge pickup: ⬜ **Silver** Hall. Thu 9-5, Fri 8-5, Sat 9-2.

Wear your badge at all times. Reprints are $5.

Free shuttle between all halls: Fri 9:30-4:30, Sat 9:30-4:00.

Parking is free. Clem calls it the best deal for a 6-day train meet in all the land.

New for October 2026

NEW

York Train Fair documentary premieres

Caleb Easter's film about York and what it means to the people who make it. Playing all day Thursday in the Verandah Room. You might be in it.

NEW

Four Verandah Room seminars

Cab 3/Base 3, the future of buying and selling, a social media panel and a manufacturers' panel. See seminars.

Wednesday Welcome Party

5:30 pm, Verandah Room. $10 covers dinner, dessert and drinks; cash bar available. Tickets: 585-683-9333, some at the door.

Pre-Show selling

Want a Pre-Show table? 8' tables are $50 for all three days. You need a PA Sales Tax License (free online). Checks to EDTCA, mailed to Russell Youens, 110 Slash Drive, Ashland VA 23995. Questions: JRYOUENS@VERIZON.NET

Free coffee and donuts, twice

Friday 7:30 am with the Standard Gauge folks in Black Hall. Saturday 7:30 am in the Orange Hall lobby, courtesy of the Eastern Division.

Last call at the Lyndon Diner

The Lyndon Diner on Route 30 closes for good in early 2027. Enjoy it while you can this October.

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

HALL HOURS ↑ CONTENTS

Bold is open to shop. Grey is setup only (no buying, selling or trading during setup). All times are am to pm, so "Open 9-6" means 9:00 am to 6:00 pm.

WHERE	MON 19	TUE 20	WED 21	THU 22	FRI 23	SAT 24
Pre-Show **Purple** **Free, everyone**	Setup 8-4	Setup 8-9 **Open 9-6**	Setup 8-8:30 **Open 9-6**	Setup 8-8:30 **Open 9-4**	-	-
Dealer halls **Orange** **Purple** **Black** **Public on Saturday only**	-	-	-	Setup 8-6	Setup 8-9 **Open 9-6**	Setup 8-9 **Open 9-4**
Member halls **Blue** **Red** **Silver** **White**	-	-	-	Setup 8-5	Setup 8-9 **Open 9-4:30**	Setup 8-9 **Open 9-4**
Registration **Silver**	-	-	-	9-5	8-5	9-2
Imagination Station (Kids Korner) **Orange Hall SE annex**	-	-	-	-	9-4	9-4
Museum & Library deaccession tables **Orange Hall**	-	-	-	-	9-6	9-3
UPS shipping **Lobby, Blue/Silver**	-	-	-	-	9-4	9-2
Free shuttle bus	-	-	-	-	9:30-4:30	9:30-4
TCA Museum & Library **Strasburg, 30 min away**	10-5	10-5	10-5	10-5	10-5	10-5

Member halls close 90 minutes before dealer halls on Friday so member table holders can shop the dealers.

Mark your calendar: future York dates

Spring: **April 23-24, 2027** · Fall: **October 22-23, 2027**. Pre-register for April 2027 at the Silver Hall desk during this show.

DAY-BY-DAY SCHEDULE

TIMES & PLACES SUBJECT TO CHANGE ↑ CONTENTS

Labels: SHOW fair hours · SEMINAR · MEETING · SOCIAL · OFF-SITE (not run by TCA unless noted)

Monday OCTOBER 19 · PRE-SHOW SETUP

8:00 am-4:00 pm SHOW **Pre-Show vendor setup**
Purple Hall

10:00 am-5:00 pm OFF-SITE **TCA National Toy Train Museum & Library open**
300 Paradise Lane, Strasburg (Ronks), PA. Free for TCA members.

10:00 am-6:00 pm OFF-SITE **Wyndham Garden Train Meet**
2000 Loucks Rd, York. Free admission.

9:00 am-5:00 pm OFF-SITE **Barry King Memorial Train Show**
Reliance Fire Hall, 1341 W Market St, York. HO, S and O. Free.

6:00-9:00 pm OFF-SITE **Pap's Modular Railroad open house**
Brookside Park Carousel Building, 4054 Fox Run Rd, Dover, PA

Tuesday OCTOBER 20 · PRE-SHOW OPENS

8:00-9:00 am SHOW **Pre-Show vendor setup**
Purple Hall

9:00 am-6:00 pm SHOW **Pre-Show open, free to everyone**
Purple Hall

10:00 am-5:00 pm OFF-SITE **TCA Museum & Library open**
Strasburg

8:00 am-6:00 pm OFF-SITE **Wyndham Garden Train Meet**
2000 Loucks Rd, York

9:00 am-5:00 pm OFF-SITE **Barry King Memorial Train Show**
Reliance Fire Hall, 1341 W Market St, York

6:00-9:00 pm OFF-SITE **Pap's Modular Railroad open house**
Brookside Park, Dover

Wednesday OCTOBER 21 · WELCOME PARTY NIGHT

8:00-8:30 am SHOW **Pre-Show setup only**
Purple Hall

9:00 am-6:00 pm	SHOW	**Pre-Show open** **Purple** Hall
9:00 am	SHOW	**On-grounds RV parking opens** Enter at Gate 6, Highland Ave. Electric available today.
10:00 am-5:00 pm	OFF-SITE	**TCA Museum & Library open** Strasburg
8:00 am-5:00 pm	OFF-SITE	**Wyndham Garden Train Meet (last day)** 2000 Loucks Rd, York
9:00 am-5:00 pm	OFF-SITE	**Barry King Memorial Train Show (last day)** Reliance Fire Hall, York
1:00 pm	MEETING	**Eastern Division Board of Directors** Orange Hall Meeting Room
2:00 pm until late	OFF-SITE	**Toy Trains Unlimited open house** 38 York St, Hanover. Food, drinks, Flyer and Lionel. "Until everyone has left or has been thrown out."
3:00-10:00 pm	OFF-SITE	**Lower Susquehanna Valley RR Club: Run What You Brung** 21 N 2nd St, Columbia, PA
5:30 pm	SOCIAL	**Welcome Party** Verandah Room. $10 includes dinner, dessert and beverages. Cash bar. Tickets 585-683-9333.
6:00-9:00 pm	OFF-SITE	**Pap's Modular Railroad open house** Brookside Park, Dover
6:00-9:00 pm	OFF-SITE	**Red Lion Train Station open house** 73 N Main St, Red Lion. O gauge layout in the historic Ma & Pa station.

Thursday OCTOBER 22 · SETUP DAY, LAST PRE-SHOW DAY

8:00-8:30 am	SHOW	**Pre-Show setup only** **Purple** Hall
8:00 am-6:00 pm	SHOW	**Dealer setup** **Orange** Hall. Dealer badges required.
9:00 am-5:00 pm	SHOW	**Member setup** **Blue** **Red** **Silver** **White** Halls. Hall badges required.
9:00 am-4:00 pm	SHOW	**Pre-Show open (final day)** **Purple** Hall
9:00 am-5:00 pm	SHOW	**Registration opens** **Silver** Hall

9:00 am-5:00 pm	SEMINAR **York Train Fair Documentary, by Caleb Easter** Verandah Room, playing all day
9:00 am	MEETING **TCA Standards Committee (open to all)** Orange Hall Meeting Room
10:00 am-5:00 pm	OFF-SITE **TCA Museum & Library open house** Strasburg
10:00 am	MEETING **"OO" Gauge meeting** Orange Hall Meeting Room · Larry Olivieri, flyerlarry@yahoo.com
12:00 noon	SOCIAL **Volunteers' free lunch & meeting** Orange Hall Promenade / concession area
2:00 pm	MEETING **National Kids Club Committee** Orange Hall Meeting Room
3:00-10:00 pm	OFF-SITE **Lower Susquehanna Valley: Run What You Brung** 21 N 2nd St, Columbia
6:30-9:00 pm	OFF-SITE **Red Lion Train Station open house** 73 N Main St, Red Lion
7:00 pm	MEETING **American Flyer "Flyer Nut" meeting** Orange Hall Meeting Room · Bob Zimmerman, rzimmerman@cyberia.com
7:00 pm	MEETING **Marx Show & Tell, the 78th in a row** Verandah Room. Doors 6:30 for setup. Ron LeClaire, rhleclaire@sbcglobal.net

Friday OCTOBER 23 · SHOW DAY ONE

7:30 am	SOCIAL **SGMA Show & Tell breakfast, free coffee & donuts** **Black** Hall. Dozens of unique standard gauge trains. Come run one.
8:00-9:00 am	SHOW **Member and dealer load-in** Hall badges required
8:00 am-5:00 pm	SHOW **Registration** **Silver** Hall
9:00 am	SHOW **National Anthem, then the doors open** Please stand tall and be proud.
9:00 am-4:30 pm	SHOW **Member halls open** **Blue** **Red** **Silver** **White**
9:00 am-6:00 pm	SHOW **Dealer halls open (members and guests)** **Orange** **Purple**

9:00 am–6:00 pm	SHOW	**Modular layouts running, SGMA layout in Black Hall** **Purple** **Black**
9:00 am–4:00 pm	SHOW	**Imagination Station (Kids Korner)** Orange Hall, southeast corner annex
9:00 am–6:00 pm	SHOW	**Museum & Library deaccession tables** **Orange** Hall
9:00 am–4:00 pm	SHOW	**UPS packing & shipping** Lobby between Blue and Silver Halls
9:30 am–4:30 pm	SHOW	**Free shuttle bus between all halls**
11:00 am–noon	MEETING	**Plasticville Collectors Association** Orange Hall Meeting Room. Bring a prized piece or new find. John Niehaus, johnln@netins.net
12:15–1:30 pm	MEETING	**Ives Train Society (all welcome)** Orange Hall Meeting Rooms A & B · Donald Lewis, dorfan@comcast.net
1:00 pm	OFF-SITE	**Toy Trains Unlimited open** 38 York St, Hanover
1:30 pm	SEMINAR	**Cab 3/Base 3: "Coming out of the Shadows," with Marty Eibeck** Verandah Room. Special guest joining.
3:00–10:00 pm	OFF-SITE	**Lower Susquehanna Valley: Run What You Brung** 21 N 2nd St, Columbia
4:30 pm	SHOW	**Member halls close**
6:00 pm	SHOW	**Dealer halls close**
6:00 pm	SOCIAL	**Ice Cream Social** Orange Hall Promenade. Sugar-free ice cream and toppings available.

Saturday OCTOBER 24 · FINAL DAY

7:30 am	SOCIAL	**Free coffee and a maple donut** Orange Hall Promenade, courtesy of the Eastern Division
8:00 am	MEETING	**Eastern Division General Membership Meeting** Orange Hall Meeting Room
8:00–9:00 am	SHOW	**Member and dealer load-in** Badges required
9:00 am–4:00 pm	SHOW	**All halls open** Members: **Blue** **Red** **Silver** **White** . Dealers, open to the public today: **Orange** **Purple** **Black**

9:00 am-2:00 pm	SHOW	**Registration desk (pre-register for April 2027)** **Silver** Hall
9:00 am-4:00 pm	SHOW	**Imagination Station (Kids Korner)** Orange Hall, southeast corner annex
9:00 am-5:00 pm	SHOW	**York Toy Train Scavenger Hunt** **Orange** Hall
9:00 am-3:00 pm	SHOW	**Museum & Library deaccession tables** **Orange** Hall
9:00 am-2:00 pm	SHOW	**UPS packing & shipping** Lobby between Blue and Silver Halls
9:30 am-4:00 pm	SHOW	**Free shuttle bus between all halls**
9:00 am	SEMINAR	**The Future of Buying and Selling Model Trains, with Michael Wax** Verandah Room. Founder of trainbid.com.
10:30 am	SEMINAR	**TCA Social Media Panel, hosted by Art Ricciardi** Verandah Room
11:00 am-6:00 pm	OFF-SITE	**Lower Susquehanna Valley: Run What You Brung** 21 N 2nd St, Columbia
1:30 pm	SEMINAR	**Model Train Manufacturers Panel, hosted by Jay Escamilla (3rd Rail)** Verandah Room. With Ross Custom Switches and Atlas O.
4:00 pm	SHOW	**All halls close. See you in the spring!**
6:00 pm	SHOW	**On-grounds RV parking closes**

SEMINARS

THURSDAY · ALL DAY

York Train Fair Documentary

Caleb Easter, Caleb Easter's Trains. Caleb started filming last spring, interviewing staff, members, vendors and guests about what York means to them and how it shaped their hobby. Come see the finished film.

FRIDAY · 1:30 PM

Cab 3/Base 3: "Coming out of the Shadows"

Marty Eibeck (YouTube), with a very special guest. Marty is the go-to person for Legacy control, and if he can't answer your question, he knows someone who can.

SATURDAY · 9:00 AM

The Future of Buying and Selling Model Trains

Michael Wax, CEO and founder of trainbid.com, a marketplace built by collectors for collectors.

SATURDAY · 10:30 AM

TCA Social Media Panel

Hosted by **Art Ricciardi** of Art's Model Trains, sharing toy trains on YouTube since 2010 and co-host of the 3 Rails 4 Dads podcast.

SATURDAY · 1:30 PM

Model Train Manufacturers Panel

Hosted by **Jay Escamilla** of 3rd Rail, joined by Ross Custom Switches and Atlas O.

LAYOUTS, CLUBS & MEETINGS

Layouts on display

LAYOUT	GAUGE & SIZE	WHERE
Standard Gauge Module Association	Standard gauge, 25' x 41' modular	■ **Black** Hall
Pittsburgh Independent Hi-Railers	O gauge, 4-track main modular	□ **White** Hall
Kids Creek Railroad / Mod Squad Gales Ferry, CT, with METCA & LCCA	O gauge, 21' x 32' and 5' x 12', kid-friendly and interactive	■ **Orange** Hall concession area
Eagle Line Railroad Ridgely, MD	O gauge, 10' x 30' and 5' x 12'	See hall maps
Lebanon Valley Rails	N scale modular	See hall maps
Maryland TTrak	N scale T-Trak, round robin	Lobby between Blue and Silver Halls
Choo Choo Barn "You Be the Engineer"	Portable 3-train layout	Imagination Station (Kids Korner)
Gerald McClellan	Two-track O gauge. Say hi to Miss Skye and Miss Blue, his four-legged crew.	RV area outside Blue Hall

Club and group meetings

Standard Gauge Module Association

Show & Tell breakfast Fri 7:30-9:00 am, ■ **Black** Hall, free coffee and donuts. Membership is free and includes quarterly Zooms and a Groups.io list. Officers: Jim Waterman (President), Ken Fischer (Secretary), Jim Kelly-Evans (Treasurer), Wayne Strobel and Kirk Lindvig (Trustees).

Marx Show & Tell

Thu 7:00 pm, Verandah Room (setup 6:30). The 78th consecutive gathering. Ron LeClaire, rhleclaire@sbcglobal.net, 708-204-6277.

Ives Train Society

Fri 12:15-1:30 pm, Orange Hall Meeting Rooms A & B. All welcome. Donald Lewis, dorfan@comcast.net.

Plasticville Collectors Association

Fri 11:00 am-noon, Orange Hall Meeting Room. Bring a prized piece. John L. Niehaus, johnln@netins.net · plasticvilleusa.org

"OO" Gauge

Thu 10:00 am, Orange Hall Meeting Room. Larry Olivieri, flyerlarry@yahoo.com.

American Flyer "Flyer Nut"

Thu 7:00 pm, Orange Hall Meeting Room. Bob Zimmerman, rzimmerman@cyberia.com.

TCA Standards Committee

Thu 9:00 am, Orange Hall Meeting Room, open to all. Every hall has a Standards member to help identify trains, boxes and paper; the list is at the Silver Hall desk.

Toy Train Paper & Memorabilia

On hiatus this October after 30 years of meetings. Updates at jlmtrains.com/ttpm.

FINDING YOUR WAY



Fairgrounds map. Paper copies at the Silver Hall registration desk. Full-size map · Hall floor plans

Hall decoder

The show uses colors. The fairgrounds signs (and the Wi-Fi networks) use building names.

SHOW NAME	FAIRGROUNDS BUILDING	WHAT'S INSIDE	HALL CAPTAIN
Orange Hall	UPMC Arena	Dealers (public on Saturday), Kids Korner, deaccession tables, TCA National tables, meeting rooms	Jack Rash & Rick Neely
Purple Hall	Heritage Hall	Pre-Show (Mon-Thu), dealers (Fri-Sat), public on Saturday	Dominic Naples
Black Hall	Banquet & Conference Center	SGMA layout and breakfast, public on Saturday	-
Silver Hall	Memorial Hall East	Members, registration and badge pickup	Bill Faust

SHOW NAME	FAIRGROUNDS BUILDING	WHAT'S INSIDE	HALL CAPTAIN
Blue Hall	Memorial Hall West	Members, sit-down food service	Bob Grebas & Miles Stanley
Red Hall	Old Main Hall	Members	Barbara Reed
White Hall	Horticulture Hall	Members, Pittsburgh Hi-Railers layout	"Buddy" Oberender

Be sure to thank your hall captains. They also have floor plans for their halls.

Services

Food

Orange Hall: large food service inside (burgers, hot dogs, fish, fries, nachos); food trucks outside (pizza, crab cakes, funnel cakes, lemonade)

Blue Hall: sit-down service at the back

Between Blue & Silver: hot dog counter with seating

Blue/Silver parking lot: BBQ, chicken strips, fries, funnel cakes

Between Red & White: burgers, funnel cakes, lemonade

Pre-Show (Mon-Thu): food truck outside Purple Hall

Restrooms & water

Inside Blue, White and Black Halls

Lobby between Blue and Silver (water fountains here)

Outside Red Hall, east side, by First Aid

Both sides of the Orange Hall Promenade (water fountains here)

Open 24/7: west side of Orange Hall Promenade (outside entrance, coin showers: $0.50 for 4 min) and the First Aid building

Clem's rule: never pass a water fountain. Steam engines and humans both need water.

Money

Four ATMs: two inside Orange Hall, one in the Blue Hall lobby, one outside Red Hall (toward White Hall).

Orange and Purple table holders need a PA Sales Tax number. State staff do visit, so have your license handy.

Health & mobility

First Aid: next to the Fire Station.

Scooters & wheelchairs: American Scooter Rentals, next to First Aid. No reservation needed.

Clem says: prep your meds, put them where you can find them, and take them.

Shipping

UPS will wrap and ship your finds. Lobby between Blue and Silver Halls. Fri 9-4, Sat 9-2.

Lost, found or stolen

Turn in found items and file lost-item reports at the Silver Hall registration desk. Coordinator Bob Heine, 301-585-1280, Robert.j.heine@gmail.com.

TCA National

The National Business Office has staffed tables in the Orange Hall lobby: membership help, applications, merchandise. Museum and Library deaccession tables are in Orange Hall, and every purchase supports them.

Visitor info

Explore York has guides, brochures and PA maps in Silver and Orange Halls. yorkpa.org

GETTING HERE

From the south (Baltimore)

Take the Baltimore Beltway (I-695) to I-83 North into Pennsylvania. Exit right onto George St (83 Business). Left on Country Club Rd, past York College. Right on S Richland Ave, left at the light onto W Market St, then right into the fairgrounds. You enter by Blue Hall.

From the north

Take I-83 South to Route 30 West. Follow Route 30 to Route 74. Turn right onto N Highland Ave, then left into the fairgrounds. You enter by Orange Hall.

Clem's traffic tip: the Carlisle Ave gate can be horrendous. Use **Gate 6 on Highland Avenue** at the northwest end (go past Orange Hall to the fence). It is always open and you can turn left or right easily.

Traffic radio

WSBA AM 910

WSOX FM 96.1

WROZ FM 101.1 "The Rose"

WGAL Channel 8 TV, every 10 min, 5-7 am

Road and weather links

PA travel info: dial 511 or 511PA.com

Local road work: York Daily Record

York weather

York Expo Center on Google Maps

RV & CAMPING

On the fairgrounds

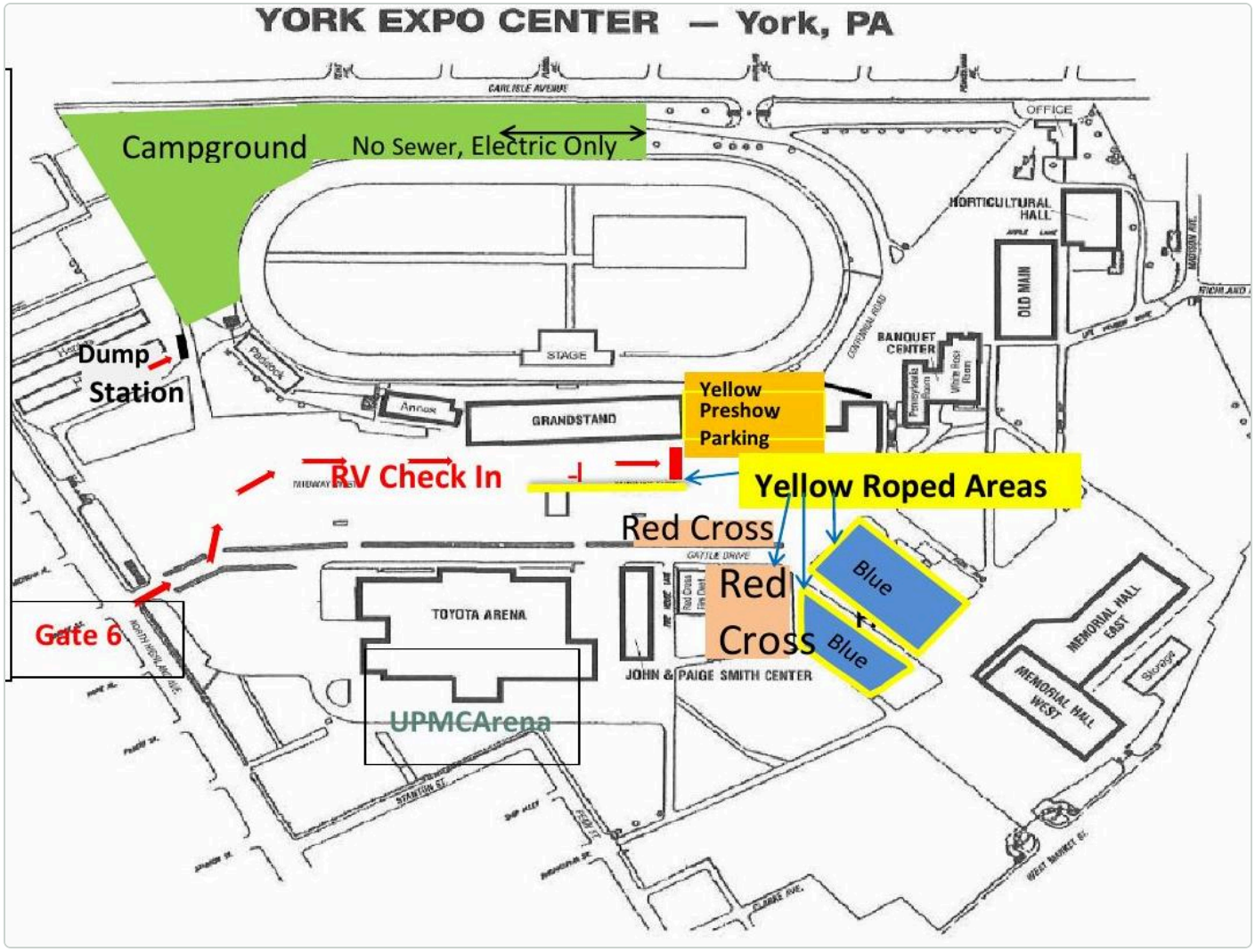
OPEN	Wed 9:00 am to Sat 6:00 pm
EARLY	Sun, Mon, Tue nights: $50 cash per night
FEE	$50 ($51 online). Required for anyone who sleeps on the grounds.
ENTER	Gate 6, Highland Ave (west side)
CONTACT	John Seresky, rv@easterntca.com, 518-234-4108. He will help you park.

No stakes through the asphalt. Electric is on Wednesday; water can take longer.

Hookups by area

CAMPGROUND	Electric, water, sewer (most), restrooms. One strip is electric only.
RED CROSS	Electric, water
BLUE	Electric, water

Dump station by the paddock. Yellow roped areas are Pre-Show parking.



RV areas and check-in route from Gate 6.

Off the grounds

Indian Rock Campground

South and west of town. Electric, water and decent showers at a reasonable nightly rate.

indianrockcampground.com

Ben Franklin RV Park

About 5 minutes west. Full hookups; good for overflow or special needs. 717-792-9612.

benfranklinrvpark.com

Gifford Pinchot State Park

Route 74, about 12 miles. Lakeside sites, great showers, very quiet. "The best place to camp." (Bob Obara)

RULES, REGISTRATION & GUESTS

Four ways to register

1. Online at yorkregistration.org
2. Call the Eastern Division Call Center, 585-683-9333
3. By mail, using the form in the Meet Notice
4. In person at the Silver Hall desk

While you're here, pre-register for April 2027.

Bringing a guest

- A guest is anyone over 18 who isn't a TCA member or applicant.
- Members can host as many guests as they like, registered in advance.
- Guests pick up their badge in person with a photo ID. Guest badges are not mailed.
- A guest can attend York once. After that, join TCA (you can join on the spot).

Show rules

- Registering means you agree to Eastern Division and TCA rules.
- Keep your badge visible at all times, and never let anyone else wear it.
- Every item on your table must be priced.
- Altered items need a TCA "Identatag" (Registration Desk or a hall captain).
- Sellers of reproduction parts must display a Certificate of Compliance.
- No buying, selling or trading during setup. Only empty boxes may leave the hall during setup.
- Still photography is fine in all halls, but not of copyrighted material. Not sure? Ask.
- Cell phones are fine; step outside for calls.
- Follow the yellow arrows on hall floors.
- No handcarts, dollies, suitcases or large backpacks in the halls.
- Single-width strollers are fine.
- No smoking, no vehicles in the halls, no alcohol on the grounds.
- Private golf carts need a $1 million liability certificate on file with the fairgrounds.
- Only licensed service or medical animals inside. Pets are fine on the grounds; clean up after them.
- Sleeping on the grounds requires the $50 RV fee.

Quick answers

Why didn't I get a Meet Notice?

Usually one of three reasons: you didn't register for a meet in the past year, you joined TCA recently, or the post office lost it. Download the member notice. Still stuck? Contact the Eastern Division.

Where should I stay?

The York County Visitors Bureau lists hotels. RVers, see RV & camping.

Can I help out?

Yes, and volunteers get free admission plus a free Thursday lunch. Needs: hall setup, registration (busiest Fri and Sat), the Orange Hall ticket booth, RV parking (80-100 units), parking signage, Pre-Show setup and Kids Korner. Contact Ben Swann, bswannrr@yahoo.com, 804-677-8545. Kids Korner also welcomes donated train items, especially complete sets.

TRAIN TRIPS BEYOND THE FAIRGROUNDS

SHOPS, OPEN HOUSES, MUSEUMS

↑ CONTENTS

Confirm hours before you drive. Most of these are not TCA events.

Open houses and other meets this week

Wyndham Garden Train Meet
2000 Loucks Rd, York · Mon 10-6, Tue 8-6, Wed 8-5 · Free · Tables 716-390-8216, chuckstrainroom.com

Barry King Memorial Train Show
Reliance Fire Hall, 1341 W Market St, York · Mon-Wed 9-5 · Free, accessible · Tables: Todd or Bev Metcalf, 860-432-2124

Pap's Modular Railroad
Brookside Park Carousel Building, 4054 Fox Run Rd, Dover · Mon-Wed 6-9 pm

Toy Trains Unlimited
38 York St, Hanover · Open house Wed from 2 pm; open Fri from 1 pm and Sat · Closed Mon and Tue of York week · 717-637-4717

Red Lion Train Station Model Railroaders
73 N Main St, Red Lion · Wed & Thu evenings · O gauge in the historic Ma & Pa station

Lower Susquehanna Valley RR Club
21 N 2nd St, Columbia · Run What You Brung: Wed-Fri 3-10 pm, Sat 11-6 · Layout nearly doubled since last fall

Choo Choo Barn
226 Gap Rd, Strasburg · Daily 10-5 · Now run by Gary Russell

Northern Central Railway (Steam into History)
17 N Front St, New Freedom · 1860s replica steam on Lincoln's route · 717-942-2370

Christmas Museum at Stone Gables Estate
1 Hollinger Lane, Elizabethtown · Train display in the interim building · 717-902-9791

Road trips from the Pittsburgh Independent Hi-Railers

Curated by Andy Hummel (TCA 08-6230) after mornings at the Pre-Show. Read Andy's full list.

Trip 1 · The York Week Wednesday Grand Tour

About 45 minutes of driving for the first three stops, then an hour to Red Lion. Arrive early and explore the town over dinner.

1. **White Rose Hobbies**, 4401 W Market St, York. Lots of hobby supplies. site
2. **Toy Trains Unlimited** open house, 38 York St, Hanover
3. **Iron Horse Trains** inside Yesteryear Antique Center, 441 Pine St, Hanover. Good in-store stock, plus antique dealers with layout-ready finds. site
4. **Red Lion Train Station** open house, 73 N Main St, Red Lion

Trip 2 · Strasburg (1 hour)

Too much for one day. Pick a few.

1. **TCA National Toy Train Museum**, 300 Paradise Ln, Ronks
2. **Choo Choo Barn** and **Strasburg Train Shop**, 226 Gap Rd. The shop carries almost the entire Arttista figure line.
3. **Strasburg Rail Road**, 301 Gap Rd, Ronks
4. **Railroad Museum of Pennsylvania**, 300 Gap Rd
5. **Barry's Car Barn**, 3504 Old Philadelphia Pike, Intercourse (15 min away). Classic cars, motorcycles and vintage train sets. Closed Sun and Mon.
6. On Wednesday, stop at the **Lower Susquehanna Valley** open house in Columbia on the way back.

Trip 3 · Gettysburg (1 hour)

1. **Carver's Toy Trains**, 305 Buford Ave. Small outside, packed inside, mostly O gauge. Mon-Sat 9-5, Sun 10:30-5. 717-334-6937
2. **Tommy Gilbert's Hobby Shop**, 346 E Water St. Modeling supplies and books. Closed Tuesdays.
3. **Lincoln Train Museum**, 425 Steinwehr Ave. Very short hours, so plan ahead.

Trip 4 · Baltimore and Mt. Airy (1.5 hours)

1. **B&O Railroad Museum**, 901 W Pratt St, Baltimore. 10-4.
2. **The Toy Exchange**, 1001 Twin Arch Rd #12, Mt. Airy, MD (40 min on). Trains and famous vintage toys. Mon-Sat 10-7, Sun noon-5.
3. Dinner at **Twin Arch Tavern**, a few doors down.

FAMILY FUN AROUND YORK

Road and bridge work is common around York County, so check before you go. Thanks to Scott Arber for gathering and maintaining this list.

Visitor information

Explore York (Visitors Bureau)
yorkpa.org · things to do, factory tours, lodging, dining

I-83 PA Welcome Center
Northbound, just above the PA/MD line · Daily 9-5:30 · 717-265-6076

Central Market York
34 W Philadelphia St · Brochure racks · Market Tue, Thu, Sat 8-2

Discover Hanover
discoverhanoverpa.org

York County History Center

One admission covers all five History Center sites on the day of your visit. 717-848-1587.

History Center Museum
121 N Pershing Ave · In the 1885 Edison power plant; a USA Today top new museum of 2024 · Tue-Sat 10-4, Sun noon-4

Library & Archives
121 N Pershing Ave · Genealogy and county records · Tue-Sat 10-4 · $12, seniors $10, students free

Agricultural & Industrial Museum
217 W Princess St · Conestoga wagon to Pullman automobile · Fri-Sat 10-4

Fire Museum of York County
757 W Market St · 1903 Royal Fire House · Sat 10-4 · 717-848-1578

Colonial Complex
157 W Market St · Golden Plough Tavern and more · Guided tours Tue-Sat 11 and 2, from the History Center

More museums

Hanover Fire Museum
134 E Hanover St, Hanover · Wed 9-3, 1st & 3rd Sat 9-3 · 717-637-6674

Indian Steps Museum
205 Indian Steps Rd, Airville · Sat-Sun 11-4 · $6, under 6 free · 717-862-3948

National Watch & Clock Museum
514 Poplar St, Columbia · Thu-Sat 10-4 · 717-684-8261

Weightlifting Hall of Fame
York Barbell, 3300 Board Rd · Mon-Thu & Sat 9-4:30, Fri 9-6 · 717-430-2031

Parks and trails

York County Heritage Rail Trail
21+ miles past Howard Tunnel, four historic bridges and Hanover Junction, where Lincoln stopped. Steam into History runs alongside.

Brookside Park, Dover
4054 Fox Run Rd · York's only surviving trolley park (1901), with its original dance hall and trolley pad

State parks
Samuel S. Lewis (717-252-1134) · Gifford Pinchot (717-423-5011) · Codorus (717-637-2816)

York County parks (dawn to dusk)
Apollo · Highpoint Scenic Vista · John C. Rudy (off-leash dog area) · Native Lands · P. Joseph Raab · Richard M. Nixon · Rocky Ridge · Spring Valley · William H. Kain

Factory tours and outlets

Utz Factory Store
861 Carlisle St, Hanover · Mon-Sat 9:30-5:30, Sun 11-5

Stauffer's Cookie Outlet
375 S Belmont St, York · 717-848-6630

York Barbell Outlet
3300 Board Rd, York · 717-430-2031

Perrydell Farm Dairy
90 Indian Rock Dam Rd, York · 717-741-3485

Bluett Bros. Violins
122 Hill St, York · By appointment, 717-825-4263

York County Solid Waste Authority
2651 Blackbridge Rd · Free tours, book 2 weeks ahead, age 6+ · 717-845-1066

Antiques

Yesteryear Antique Center
441 Pine St, Hanover · 717-637-1612 (Iron Horse Trains is inside)

Black Rose Antiques
1100 Eichelberger St, Hanover · 717-632-0589

Burning Bridge Antique Market
304 Walnut St, Columbia · 717-684-7900

Dover Antique Mall
5020 Carlisle Rd, Dover · 717-292-2629

Greybeards of Jacobus
51 N Main St, Jacobus · 717-428-9316

Lewisberry Antique & Crafts
206 Market St, Lewisberry · 717-938-3200

Golf and performing arts

Public golf
Briarwood · Cool Creek · Grandview · Heritage Hills · Hickory Heights · Honey Run · Little Creek · Pleasant Valley · Range End · Royal Manchester · Valley Green

Performing arts
Appell Center, 50 N George St, York (717-846-1111) · Eichelberger Center, Hanover (717-637-7086)

Where to eat

York has more than 364 restaurants (Tripadvisor list). Call ahead for reservations. Spots the Primer crew mentioned this year:

Lyndon Diner
Route 30 · Closing for good in early 2027

Graybill's Route 30 Diner
Abbottstown

Rivertowne Bar & Grill
Wrightsville · Near the Columbia club

The New Era Restaurant
Abbottstown · Wing night



Welcome to York

Bob Buehler, Eastern Division President · buehlster@aol.com

On behalf of the Eastern Division, it is my pleasure to welcome you to another York Train Fair. Whether this is your first visit or you have been attending for decades, I hope you enjoy everything that makes York such a special tradition: the trains, the discoveries, and, most importantly, the friendships renewed throughout the halls.

As I prepare to conclude my time serving as President of the Eastern Division, this York carries special meaning for me. It has been a tremendous honor and privilege to serve our membership. I am deeply grateful for the confidence you placed in me and for the encouragement and friendship you have shown throughout my tenure.

The Eastern Division's success is made possible by the officers, directors, committee members, volunteers, and countless others who contribute their time and talents. York simply could not happen without their dedication. I extend my sincere thanks to every person who has worked behind the scenes to support the Division and make this meet possible.

Although my time as President is coming to an end, my commitment to the Eastern Division and the York tradition will continue. I look forward to remaining involved, supporting our future leadership, and sharing many more York memories with all of you.

Thank you for giving me the privilege of serving as your President. Please enjoy the show, support our vendors, welcome our guests, and take time to appreciate the fellowship that has made York such an important part of our hobby for generations. Welcome to York and thank you for being part of the Eastern Division family.

Clem's (and Ryan's) Report

A day-by-day look back at Spring York, April 2026, by Ryan Newman

Sunday. We arrived Sunday afternoon and unloaded into the Purple Hall for the Pre-Show. As has become tradition, the wind was raging and keeping things very cool. A great turnout of vendors: 1932 Blue 400TW tenders with original boxes, and probably the most Ives tenders ever for sale in one place. Marty V stopped by as we set up. Dinner at the Lyndon Diner on Route 30. I had the French toast.

Monday. The Pre-Show opened at 7:30 am so vendors could finish setting up. Donuts were plentiful, though from Walmart, on a rumor that maple donuts might not arrive in time. Good crowd, as usual on Mondays. Katie and Rupert were across from us in their usual spot. Lots of nice McCoy cars, and a homemade standard gauge switcher built from what looks like an 8 shell. Good sales day, and I acquired a few more trains myself. Dinner at Rivertowne Bar and Grill in Wrightsville; Robert and I split a large supreme pizza.

Tuesday. Breakfast and lunch sandwiches from the Rutter's in Abbottstown, where the ladies check the Eastern Division website to know when we're in town. One of them had asked about a train set on the cheap, and she and her husband are now proud owners of a 2026 with a 2466WX tender, three freight cars, a 6457 lighted caboose, track and a transformer. Robert handed out serendipitous gifts to fellow sellers (Katie got a music box match box). We closed the night at the Welcome Party in its new home, the Verandah Room: quieter, nicer, and you can actually talk. BBQ chicken, spareribs, baked potato, macaroni salad, tossed salad and three kinds of cobbler.

Wednesday. Another Pre-Show complete. I sold lots of "Majestic" items and picked up some very nice ones. A Märklin One Gauge brass tunnel and a large One Gauge live steamer appeared in the Purple Hall, which the OGR Forum called "Majestic." The volunteer lunch had a great turnout, and Kids Korner setup began as Mighty Casey returned. Dinner at Graybill's Route 30 Diner: the Salisbury steak special. It was Majestic.

Thursday. Members moved into their halls. I heard a loud rumble outside, wandered to the Black Hall, and met Rupert Campbell coming out. "Yeah! STOMPER arrived!" There sat STOMPER on the SGMA layout, apparently powered to the fairgrounds by gravity waves. Decent crowd, closed at 6. Wing night at the New Era in Abbottstown.

Friday. My plan was the SGMA show and tell and, finally, a maple donut. But at 7:25 am fair maintenance was waiting for me to unlock the Purple Hall. Duty calls. By the time I was free, the donuts were gone. Good sales day anyway. Purple Hall had the best pricing on McCoy convention cars. I bought an original-paint 752W set, felt unsure about the price, then found a boxed one in Silver Hall with better paint, worse frames, likely swapped vestibules, at 1.5 times what I paid. Boxes are nice, but you can't run the boxes. That night we visited the Lower Susquehanna club's Run What You Brung; they've almost doubled their layout since October.

> ***A word from Clem himself***

> *Guys and gals, Saturday is not the end of all. It is the beginning of all. Think of what has happened to you and yours, kids and friends. You got lots of new friends and lots of new stories right here. When you're playing golf at the 13th hole you can say, let me tell you about what this guy paid for this stupid engine. Collect the business cards you picked up and get them in your address book, because you're going to want to call Louie, who offered you a Blue Comet for 40 bucks. Take notes on where you ate dinner, so next year you know where you were.*
>
> *Please think about how amazing this is. There are people, registration and financial folks, who work so the rest of us can play trains and have fun. Don't forget it. God bless those folks serving under the Red, White and Blue. I'll see you guys this fall. Good night, everybody.* ***Clem***

Friday night, the part I forgot. The Ice Cream Social included a special presentation. Last year the Eastern Division created an award for members who have made an impact on the division and exemplify the purpose of TCA. It is named for its first recipient, Richard "Clem" Clement. The second Richard "Clem" Clement Award went to **Hope Danielson**.

Saturday. I finally got my maple donut. During coffee and donuts, longtime York attendee and TCA member Eddie Goldman was remembered; his daughter Lisa was there. And to anyone who says York isn't what it used to be: Kids Korner had over 80 kids on Saturday alone, and stayed open until 1 pm instead of noon because it couldn't close. I spent the day walking the grounds with my nephew, introducing him to friends in every hall. Just before the member halls closed, a steady rain began, as if Mother Nature were sad that York was ending for six months.

As Clem wrote, whatever comes next, we keep the memories and friends from this York and all the ones before it.

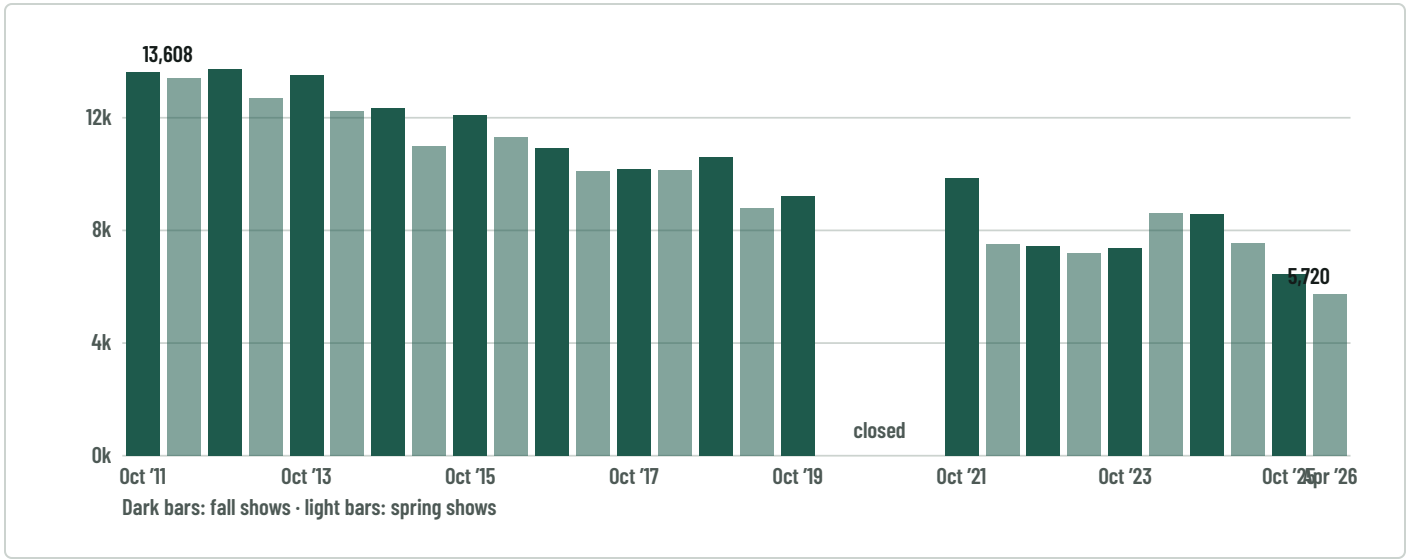
REFERENCE

Who to contact

FOR	WHO	HOW
Emergencies on the grounds	York Expo Center	717-848-2596
Registration, Welcome Party tickets	Eastern Division Call Center	585-683-9333
Pre-Show tables	Russell Youens, Pre-Show Coordinator	JRYOUENS@VERIZON.NET
RV parking	John Seresky, RV Chair	rv@easterntca.com · 518-234-4108
Volunteering	Ben Swann	bswannrr@yahoo.com · 804-677-8545
Lost & found	Bob Heine	Robert.j.heine@gmail.com · 301-585-1280
Imagination Station	Rob Newman, Eastern TCA board	easterntca.com/imagination-station
TCA Museum & Library volunteering	Strasburg	717-687-8623
Questions about this Primer	Ryan Newman, editor	conrail5065@yahoo.com
Say thanks to Clem	Richard "Clem" Clement	r.clem.clement@gmail.com

York attendance over the years

Total registrations as reported by the Primer (unofficial). The show was closed April 2020 through April 2021.



Join TCA

Regular

$50 per year

Full membership: vote, hold office, sell at meets. Apply online

Trial

$20 for 6 months, one time

All publications and meets, but no voting, office or selling. Then apply as Regular. Start a trial

Junior (under 18)

$25 per year

Needs a parent/guardian approval form. No selling or voting. Half-price Regular dues until 24. Apply

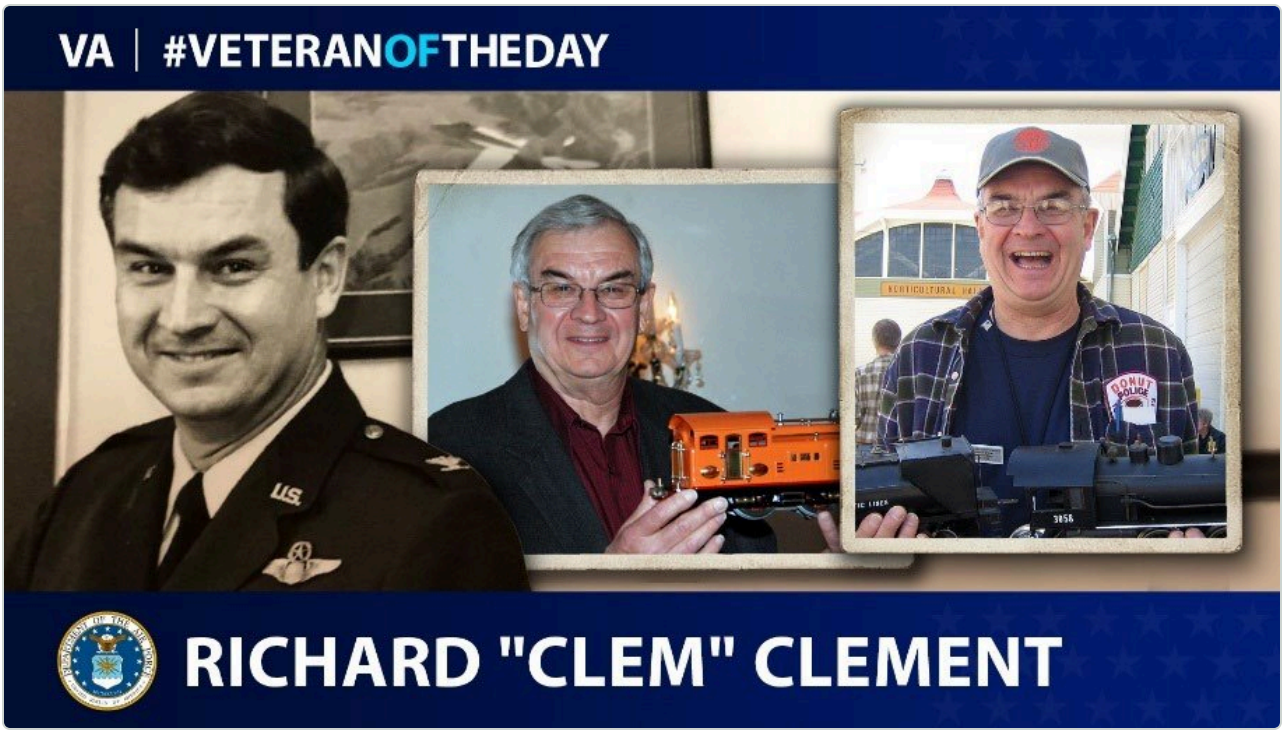
Prefer mail? Print the application and send to Membership, Train Collectors Association, PO Box 248, Strasburg, PA 17579. Slower to process.

About the Primer

Clem's Primer began many years ago as the personal experiences and views of Richard "Clem" Clement: TCA Past President, Eastern Division Past President, past TCA Director, past WB&A Chapter Vice President and board member, and most importantly a TCA member in good standing. Carol R. McGinnis, TCA Past President and Heritage Member, authored it through April 2024. It is now edited by Eastern Division member Ryan Newman, with information gathered from many sources.

The Primer is meant to enrich your York experience. It is not sponsored by any organization and does not endorse any product. The Eastern Division York Train Show Notice is the official newsletter. This edition replaces all previous versions. Past editions.

OUR NAMESAKE



Richard "Clem" Clement, as featured in the VA's #VeteranOfTheDay series.

Clem Clement, TCA Honor Roll #64-987, is the namesake of this well-read and well-distributed TCA publication. He and his wife Sandy continue to add their expertise, wit, and by default his name to this publication. His knowledge and experiences add to the details and to the fun. Just ask him!

He loves to ask the "hard" questions, bring up history and mention members by name, and he challenges each of us to increase our love and knowledge of trains and to increase TCA membership.

Thanks, Clem!

r.clem.clement@gmail.com